

Equality Impact Assessment [version 2.12]



Title: Workplace Parking Levy – Stage One Development and Outline Business Case	
☒ Policy ☐ Strategy ☐ Function ☐ Service ☐ Other [please state]	☐ New ☒ Already exists / review ☐ Changing
Directorate: Growth and Regeneration	Lead Officer name: Laura Gosling
Service Area: City Transport	Lead Officer role: Transport Programme Manager

Step 1: What do we want to do?

The purpose of an Equality Impact Assessment is to assist decision makers in understanding the impact of proposals as part of their duties under the Equality Act 2010. Detailed guidance to support completion can be found here [Equality Impact Assessments \(EqIA\) \(sharepoint.com\)](#).

This assessment should be started at the beginning of the process by someone with a good knowledge of the proposal and service area, and sufficient influence over the proposal. It is good practice to take a team approach to completing the equality impact assessment. Please contact the [Equality and Inclusion Team](#) early for advice and feedback.

1.1 What are the aims and objectives/purpose of this proposal?

Briefly explain the purpose of the proposal and why it is needed. Describe who it is aimed at and the intended aims / outcomes. Where known also summarise the key actions you plan to undertake. Please use plain English, avoiding jargon and acronyms. Equality Impact Assessments are viewed by a wide range of people including decision-makers and the wider public.

The Committee Report outlines Bristol City Council's proposed approach to developing a Workplace Parking Levy (WPL) scheme and associated Outline Business Case.

A WPL is an annual charge paid to the Local Transport Authority by employers on the workplace parking spaces they provide. Employers have the option to pass this cost on to their employees or pay the charge themselves. The aim is to encourage employers to manage the number of workplace parking spaces they provide, whilst promoting and encouraging the use of sustainable transport

A WPL forms a potential part of Bristol City Council's transport strategy and is outlined in Joint Local Transport Plan 4 and the Bristol Transport Strategy as a key demand management measure aimed at tackling congestion, particularly at peak times, and as a means of providing significant additional revenue for transport improvements across the city. The introduction of a WPL would help discourage car commuting and help increase the use of alternative modes such as walking, cycling and public transport which would in turn, improve people's health and the local environment. A WPL would also provide significant additional revenue for transport improvements across the city.

The powers to introduce a Workplace Parking Levy are contained in the Transport Act 2000. By law, net proceeds from a Workplace Parking Levy are only available for the purpose of directly or indirectly facilitating achievement of local transport policies and objectives.

1.2 Who will the proposal have the potential to affect?

☒ Bristol City Council workforce	☒ Service users	☒ The wider community
☒ Commissioned services	☒ City partners / Stakeholder organisations	
Additional comments:		

1.3 Will the proposal have an equality impact?

Could the proposal affect access levels of representation or participation in a service, or does it have the potential to change e.g. quality of life: health, education, or standard of living etc.?

If 'No' explain why you are sure there will be no equality impact, then skip steps 2-4 and request review by Equality and Inclusion Team.

If 'Yes' complete the rest of this assessment, or if you plan to complete the assessment at a later stage please state this clearly here and request review by the Equality and Inclusion Team.

☒ Yes	☐ No	[please select]
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Step 2: What information do we have?

2.1 What data or evidence is there which tells us who is, or could be affected?

Please use this section to demonstrate an understanding of who could be affected by the proposal. Include general population data where appropriate, and information about people who will be affected with particular reference to protected and other relevant characteristics: [How we measure equality and diversity \(bristol.gov.uk\)](https://www.bristol.gov.uk/how-we-measure-equality-and-diversity)

Use one row for each evidence source and say which characteristic(s) it relates to. You can include a mix of qualitative and quantitative data e.g. from national or local research, available data or previous consultations and engagement activities.

Outline whether there is any over or under representation of equality groups within relevant services - don't forget to benchmark to the local population where appropriate. Links to available data and reports are here [Data, statistics and intelligence \(sharepoint.com\)](#). See also: [Bristol Open Data \(Quality of Life, Census etc.\)](#); [Joint Strategic Needs Assessment \(JSNA\)](#); [Ward Statistical Profiles](#).

For workforce / management of change proposals you will need to look at the diversity of the affected teams using available evidence such as [HR Analytics: Power BI Reports \(sharepoint.com\)](#) which shows the diversity profile of council teams and service areas. Identify any over or under-representation compared with Bristol economically active citizens for different characteristics. Additional sources of useful workforce evidence include the [Employee Staff Survey Report](#) and [Stress Risk Assessment](#)

Data / Evidence Source [Include a reference where known]	Summary of what this tells us
Bristol City Council WPL Feasibility Report (2011)	The study undertaken by Atkins in 2011 provided high level estimates of the number of parking spaces that could be encompassed in a WPL scheme based three different defined areas in Bristol. These range from a lower estimate of 8,600 parking spaces for a smaller central zone to an upper estimate of 57,000 for a scheme covering the entire city. The WPL Feasibility Study undertaken by Nottingham City Council in 2021 notes that without undertaking a more detailed and

	up to date audit of spaces, the accuracy of these figures is likely to be low.
Bristol Quality of Life Survey 2024/25	71 % of respondents think that air quality and traffic pollution is a problem locally which suggests that there is majority support for initiatives that seek to reduce the impacts of car use in the city. 83% of people think that traffic congestion is a problem locally which suggests broad support for measures that reduce levels of traffic in the city. In the previous years' survey this percentage was lower, suggesting local people feel congestion has got worse since 2023. Based on data from the previous Quality of Life Survey in 2023/24, 36% of respondents state that they drive to work (2% car share) which suggests, depending on the coverage of the WPL scheme, that a significant number of people would be impacted by the proposal. The Quality of Life survey suggests older people (40.6%), carers (43.5%), single parents (50%) and those living in the 10% most deprived areas (41.7%) are significantly more likely than Bristol average (36.7%) to drive to work. Disabled people (25.8%) and younger people between 16-24 (26.8%) are less likely to drive to work. There are also significant disparities in the extent to which people in Bristol find lack of transport options prevents them leaving their house when they want to - in particular for young people, Disabled people, Black Asian and minoritised communities, LGBTQ+, carers and those living in the most deprived areas.
NOMIS Nomis - Official Census and Labour Market Statistics (nomisweb.co.uk)	Bristol has approximately 18,330 registered businesses with a higher proportion of small (10 to 49 employees) and large (250+ employees) employers than the South West regional average. More work is required to understand the allocation of parking spaces across these businesses as it is likely that many (particularly among micro and small businesses) will have no allocated parking and therefore will not be impacted by the scheme.
Travel to Work Survey Bristol, March 2025	Bristol's Travel to Work Survey results reveal that 31% of employees travel to work by car (with an additional 6% car sharing). On average, people driving to work travel in 3.2 days per week and travel an average distance of 35 miles a day. The latter statistic demonstrates that many commuters are travelling into Bristol from outside of the local authority boundary and that the WPL will have impacts beyond Bristol. The survey notes that there is a relatively equal split between men (30%) and women (32%) who drive to

	work. <i>(It should be noted that the percentages don't add up to 100% because of the option 'Prefer not to say')</i> In line with the Quality of Life Survey, the Travel to Work Survey highlights that people 50+ (39%) are more likely to drive to work than younger people under 30 (21%). The survey identifies that people driving to work are more likely to be from a white ethnic background (33%) than an ethnic minority group (24%) Unlike the Quality of Life Survey, the Travel to Work Survey suggests that an almost equal proportion of Disabled (32%) and non-Disabled people (31%) travel to work by car.
Bristol Walking and Cycling Index (2023)	The Bristol Walking and Cycling Index, which is updated every 2 years, polls a representative example of Bristol's population (circa 1,000 respondents). The survey reveals data that would support the aims and objectives of a WPL scheme: • 49% of people want to walk, wheel or cycle more • 35% of people want to take public transport more • 29% of people want to drive less In addition to the report notes that 64% of people want more investment in walking and wheeling, 58% more investment in cycling, 83% more investment in public transport and only 23% more investment in driving.
Global Traffic Scorecard INRIX Global Traffic Rankings	Congestion costs the UK economy £7.8 billion annually (2024), up 11% from 2023. Bristol drivers lose an average of 65 hours each year to congestion, making the city the second most congested in the UK, after London (101 hours) and ahead of Leeds (60 hours) and Manchester (61 hours).
Bristol traffic report TomTom Traffic Index	In 2024, Bristol recorded an average congestion level of 34%, which is 2 percentage points higher than 2023, indicating worsening traffic conditions. The average travel time for a 6-mile journey was 22 minutes and 1 second, up by 9 seconds from the previous year. Over the year, drivers spent an additional 87 hours in rush-hour traffic, equivalent to 3 days and 15 hours, which is 5 hours and 21 minutes more than in 2023.
Additional comments:	

2.2 Do you currently monitor relevant activity by the following protected characteristics?

☒ Age	☒ Disability	☒ Gender Reassignment
☒ Marriage and Civil Partnership	☒ Pregnancy/Maternity	☒ Race
☒ Religion or Belief	☒ Sex	☒ Sexual Orientation

2.3 Are there any gaps in the evidence base?

Where there are gaps in the evidence, or you don't have enough information about some equality groups, include an equality action to find out in section 4.2 below. This doesn't mean that you can't complete the assessment without the information, but you need to follow up the action and if necessary, review the assessment later. If you are unable to fill in the gaps, then state this clearly with a justification.

For workforce related proposals all relevant characteristics may not be included in HR diversity reporting (e.g. pregnancy/maternity). For smaller teams diversity data may be redacted. A high proportion of not known/not disclosed may require an action to address under-reporting.

A lot of relevant data exists on the commuting habits of Bristol's residents, but the following gaps remain:

- Whether different groups currently pay for parking or are offered free parking at their workplace.
- An accurate picture of the number of employee parking bays that may form part of the scheme.
- The ability of employers and employees to meet additional costs.

2.4 How have you involved communities and groups that could be affected?

You will nearly always need to involve and consult with internal and external stakeholders during your assessment. The extent of the engagement will depend on the nature of the proposal or change. This should usually include individuals and groups representing different relevant protected characteristics. Please include details of any completed engagement and consultation and how representative this had been of Bristol's diverse communities.

Include the main findings of any engagement and consultation in Section 2.1 above.

If you are managing a workforce change process or restructure please refer to [Managing a change process or restructure \(sharepoint.com\)](#) for advice on consulting with employees etc. Relevant stakeholders for engagement about workforce changes may include e.g. staff-led groups and trades unions as well as affected staff.

Presently only a Feasibility Study has been undertaken in relation to the WPL scheme. However, this outlines in detail the key stakeholders that need to be involved and sets out a recommended approach to consulting with them. Further engagement is planned as part of the development of this OBC.

2.5 How will engagement with stakeholders continue?

Explain how you will continue to engage with stakeholders throughout the course of planning and delivery. Please describe where more engagement and consultation is required and set out how you intend to undertake it. Include any targeted work to seek the views of under-represented groups. If you do not intend to undertake it, please set out your justification. You can ask the Equality and Inclusion Team for help in targeting particular groups.

The scheme has been subject to an initial Feasibility Study which outlines a Stakeholder Management Strategy for future stages of project development. This highlights the need for extensive public consultation as well as delivering a communications plan which sets out how key stakeholders (e.g. employers) will be kept updated and informed at key stages of the project. The next stage of development will advance the stakeholder strategy and communication plan, and any scheme will be subject to public consultation and committee sign off before delivery.

Step 3: Who might the proposal impact?

Analysis of impacts must be rigorous. Please demonstrate your analysis of any impacts of the proposal in this section, referring to evidence you have gathered above and the characteristics protected by the Equality Act 2010. Also include details of existing issues for particular groups that you are aware of and are seeking to address or mitigate through this proposal. See detailed guidance documents for advice on identifying potential impacts etc. [Equality Impact Assessments \(EqIA\) \(sharepoint.com\)](https://sharepoint.com)

3.1 Does the proposal have any potentially adverse impacts on people based on their protected or other relevant characteristics?

Consider sub-categories and how people with combined characteristics (e.g. young women) might have particular needs or experience particular kinds of disadvantage.

Where mitigations indicate a follow-on action, include this in the 'Action Plan' Section 4.2 below.

GENERAL COMMENTS (highlight any potential issues that might impact all or many groups)
The introduction of a WPL will have a range of impacts for different protected characteristic groups but the full details of these impacts will not be clear until the necessary development work has been undertaken to understand the size, scope and pricing strategy of the scheme. Therefore, this EQIA will need to be continuously reviewed and updated as the project progresses. A final decision on any WPL scheme will need to be taken by Committee at which point an updated EQIA will be provided. The WPL scheme is still at an early stage of development with key details such as pricing, scope and potential exemptions not yet determined. As such, this EQIA is proportional to the level of detail currently available. The analysis of the data suggests there is high levels of support for measures that improve conditions for walking, cycling and public transport and for securing more investment for these modes. Residents want to drive less and walk, cycle, and use public transport more. Where certain equality groups may rely more on driving to work due to accessibility or safety barriers on public transport, this impact may be partially mitigated through investment in public transport infrastructure improvements. The scheme is likely to have an impact on a significant number of commuters who drive to work and of that group it is not unreasonable to suggest that people on lower incomes will likely find it harder to meet additional costs if their employer passes the cost of the WPL scheme on to them. The analysis finds that older people make up a greater proportion of people who travel to work by car and therefore they are more likely to be impacted by the scheme than other groups. Whilst a levy would be for the employer not the employee, there is a strong possibility that charges would be passed on directly to employees or the overall number of car parking spaces reduced - so impacts below have been assessed on that basis. Disabled people who hold Blue Badges are likely to be exempt, but disabled employees without a badge and those with mobility needs could still be affected if parking is reduced. Night and shift workers, who often rely on cars due to limited public transport at unsocial hours, may also face disproportionate impacts. In the council's cumulative equality impact assessment for the 2025-26 Budget, we recognise that increased charges and levies could disproportionately affect small businesses and the local voluntary and community sector. This impact is especially significant for organisations led by or supporting equality groups, as higher costs may prevent smaller providers from continuing to offer equitable services to Bristol's diverse population. As part of the feasibility study, we will evaluate potential indirect impacts on specific users and assess whether discretionary concessions for voluntary and community sector or equality-led stakeholders are appropriate and feasible. A previous scoping study identified that concessions could be made for specific groups, such as blue badge holders, small businesses, and NHS facilities etc. Analysis at this stage is limited to consideration of the direct impact of a levy on employees and has not considered any potential additional pressure on on-street parking, as the levy would apply to the parking space

itself rather than the vehicle. The project plan includes a study to identify any potential displaced commuter parking.

PROTECTED CHARACTERISTICS

Age: Young People	Does your analysis indicate a disproportionate impact? Yes ☒ No ☐
Potential impacts:	Younger people are less likely to be reliant on a car to get to work. The reduction in congestion and re-investment of fees into improved public transport options will provide a disproportionate benefit to this group. Improved access to transport schemes and initiatives will help ensure this group have a good start in life.
Mitigations:	None identified at this stage – to be considered in feasibility study
Age: Older People	Does your analysis indicate a disproportionate impact? Yes ☒ No ☐
Potential impacts:	This group is more likely to be driven to work and as such is likely to be disproportionately impacted by the proposal if employers decide to pass on costs to them. That said, the Quality-of-Life survey 2024/25 shows that the number of people from the 50+ age group that state that they ‘find it difficult to manage financially’ is much lower than the Bristol average.
Mitigations:	None identified at this stage – to be considered in feasibility study
Disability	Does your analysis indicate a disproportionate impact? Yes ☒ No ☐
Potential impacts:	A WPL scheme could potentially have an adverse impact on Disabled employees who need a car in order to maintain a quality of life and access to employment. A WPL could also adversely impact a Disabled person who may need to incorporate other tasks into their commute to work (trip chaining) such as attending necessary appointments in order to maintain their health.
Mitigations:	Consider exception for all Disabled Employees. The Blue Badge scheme may offer partial mitigations for those Disabled employees who have them, and some employers may already have designated spaces for Disabled People.
Sex	Does your analysis indicate a disproportionate impact? Yes ☒ No ☐
Potential impacts:	Women are statistically more likely to hold caring responsibilities for children and older adults and would therefore be disproportionately affected if they need to incorporate other tasks into their commute to work (trip chaining) such as the school run, caring for or helping with tasks for older adults
Mitigations:	No mitigation identified unless the scheme included discretionary exemptions for employees with caring responsibilities.
Sexual orientation	Does your analysis indicate a disproportionate impact? Yes ☒ No ☐
Potential impacts:	Quality of Life survey data suggests a higher than average proportion of LGBTQ+ people in Bristol find lack of transport options prevents them leaving their house when they want to.
Mitigations:	None identified at this stage – to be considered in feasibility study
Pregnancy / Maternity	Does your analysis indicate a disproportionate impact? Yes ☒ No ☐
Potential impacts:	As above, those with caring responsibilities may need to incorporate other tasks into the commute to work (trip chaining) Pregnant employees may be more dependent on having their own transport for pre-natal appointments or if they find public transport inaccessible
Mitigations:	No mitigation identified unless the scheme included discretionary exemptions for pregnant employees.
Gender reassignment	Does your analysis indicate a disproportionate impact? Yes ☐ No ☒
Potential impacts:	Quality of Life survey data suggests a higher than average proportion of LGBTQ+ people in Bristol find lack of transport options prevents them leaving their house when they want to.
Mitigations:	None identified at this stage – to be considered in feasibility study
Race	Does your analysis indicate a disproportionate impact? Yes ☒ No ☐
Potential impacts:	Black, Asian and minoritised ethnic households in the UK are more likely to be in deep poverty and experience higher levels of material deprivation. As such, if employers pass

	on WPL scheme costs to these groups they may find it harder to meet these additional costs.
Mitigations:	None identified at this stage – to be considered in feasibility study
Religion or Belief	Does your analysis indicate a disproportionate impact? Yes ☐ No ☒
Potential impacts:	
Mitigations:	
Marriage & civil partnership	Does your analysis indicate a disproportionate impact? Yes ☐ No ☒
Potential impacts:	
Mitigations:	
OTHER RELEVANT CHARACTERISTICS	
Socio-Economic (deprivation)	Does your analysis indicate a disproportionate impact? Yes ☒ No ☐
Potential impacts:	The Quality-of-Life Survey suggests that people living in areas of deprivation are slightly more likely to drive to work than the city average. If employers pass on WPL scheme costs to these groups they may find it harder to meet these additional costs
Mitigations:	See general comments above
Carers	Does your analysis indicate a disproportionate impact? Yes ☒ No ☐
Potential impacts:	As above – those who hold caring responsibilities for children and older adults may therefore be disproportionately affected if they need to incorporate other tasks into their commute to work (trip chaining)
Mitigations:	No mitigation identified unless the scheme included discretionary exemptions for employees with caring responsibilities.
Other groups [Please add additional rows below to detail the impact for any other relevant groups as appropriate e.g. asylum seekers and refugees; care experienced; homelessness; armed forces personnel and veterans]	
Potential impacts:	
Mitigations:	

3.2 Does the proposal create any benefits for people based on their protected or other relevant characteristics?

Outline any potential benefits of the proposal and how they can be maximised. Identify how the proposal will support our [Public Sector Equality Duty](#) to:

- ✓ Eliminate unlawful discrimination for a protected group
- ✓ Advance equality of opportunity between people who share a protected characteristic and those who don't
- ✓ Foster good relations between people who share a protected characteristic and those who don't

How people move around the city is intrinsically linked to equality and inclusion. We know that many protected characteristic groups are more likely to suffer the negative impacts of car use, such as congestion, poor air quality, traffic accidents and unhealthy physical environments, whilst at the same time having more limited access and use of vehicles. In addition, we know that these groups are much more reliant on walking and public transport as a means of accessing work, education, training, and services. (Transport and inequality: An evidence review for the Department for Transport, NatCen, 2019).

This proposal is in line with the Bristol Transport Strategy that seeks to rebalance the transport system to ensure that car use is priced fairly compared with walking, cycling and public transport. Cars take up a disproportionate amount of space on public highway which limits the use of that space for more investment in sustainable modes of transport (e.g. bike and bus lanes and wider pavements). The introduction of a WPL has benefits associated with a reduction in car use and a subsequent increase in the use of alternative modes such as walking, cycling and public transport. By increasing the tariffs

associated with car ownership we may be able to encourage people to re-evaluate the need to own a vehicle. A reduction in the number of car trips will have a beneficial impact on air quality. In turn this will have a positive impact on people's health.

Step 4: Impact

4.1 How has the equality impact assessment informed or changed the proposal?

What are the main conclusions of this assessment? Use this section to provide an overview of your findings. This summary can be included in decision pathway reports etc.

If you have identified any significant negative impacts which cannot be mitigated, provide a justification showing how the proposal is proportionate, necessary, and appropriate despite this.

Summary of significant negative impacts and how they can be mitigated or justified:

Depending on how the scheme is designed the EQIA at this stage has highlighted that there are impacts on various groups that need to be considered during the development of the business case. This includes potential disproportionate impacts on Black, Asian and minoritised ethnic groups, older people (50+) and people in social deprivation.

Summary of positive impacts / opportunities to promote the Public Sector Equality Duty:

Depending on how the scheme is designed there are likely to be a number of benefits for different protected characteristic groups who often negative impacts of car use – such as congestion, poor air quality, traffic accidents and unhealthy physical environments, whilst at the same time having more limited access and use of vehicles.

The WPL revenue will be ring-fenced for investment in public transport, walking, and cycling infrastructure, which can improve accessibility for groups with lower car ownership (e.g., younger people, some older adults, Disabled people without Blue Badges, and low-income households).

4.2 Action Plan

Use this section to set out any actions you have identified to improve data, mitigate issues, or maximise opportunities etc. If an action is to meet the needs of a particular protected group please specify this.

Improvement / action required	Responsible Officer	Timescale
To review and update the EQIA through the development of the business case	Laura Gosling	Review quarterly and/or key project milestones

4.3 How will the impact of your proposal and actions be measured?

How will you know if you have been successful? Once the activity has been implemented this equality impact assessment should be periodically reviewed to make sure your changes have been effective your approach is still appropriate.

A monitoring and evaluation strategy will be developed for the WPL scheme as part of the proposed business case.

Step 5: Review

The Equality and Inclusion Team need at least five working days to comment and feedback on your EqIA. EqIAs should only be marked as reviewed when they provide sufficient information for decision-makers on the equalities

impact of the proposal. Please seek feedback and review from the [Equality and Inclusion Team](#) before requesting sign off from your Director¹.

Equality and Inclusion Team Review: <i>Reviewed by Equality and Inclusion Team</i>	Director Sign-Off: 
Date: 19/09/2025	Date: 2 nd October 2025

¹ Review by the Equality and Inclusion Team confirms there is sufficient analysis for decision makers to consider the likely equality impacts at this stage. This is not an endorsement or approval of the proposal.